

Thread - 2026-08-23

<https://x.com/RiikonenMarko/status/2091550602627027350>

1/1 - 2026-08-23 15:38 UTC

Mongolia must be big. Also the Taklamakan desert. In meteograms, Hotan, Kashgar have profusion of high clouds and little low clouds. Actually, Taklamakan area may be the very area you wonder about. It may have also good elliptical halo scene.

But could be that in tropics you get the most halo days a month, a year and the longest continuous stretches. In Philippines I got 50 halo days in a row. It's enough to get a glimpse from between the lower clouds. I have analyzed, from meteograms, a couple of places that I have thought have plenty of highs clouds, and among those the most high cloudy place is Buenaventura in Colombia. But it is also very rainy. In India, a special area seems to be the southern tip. In the summer, Madurai has long stretches of high clouds with little lower clouds.

But really interests me most is finding out is whether there is a summer elliptical halo belt from around Georgia to Taklamakan. If I ever embark on halo tourism again, that will be a full summer in Georgia. If I am right about the middle cloud signal in meteograms (there is a specific looking signal), this belt may stretch south down to Sahara and Riyadh, though the action is more intermittent in these very dry locations.

Going for elliptical halo project means you need to have two automatic cameras: one for the elliptical halos and another one with a wider view to catch any possible anomalous zenith/horizon arc or other halo from those crystals.
